Jack Le

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Education

The University of Texas at Dallas Dec 2026 (expected)
BS in Computer Science with Honors; minors in Mathematics and Political Science
GPA: 3.97/4.0 | Collegium V Honors, Phi Kappa Phi, Dean's List (3 semesters)

Waseda University, Computer Science and Engineering Sep 2024 - Aug 2025
Exchange year; coursework and research conducted in Japanese

Publications and Preprints

** Equal contribution*

Refereed Abstract and Workshop Paper

Le, J. Do Machines Struggle Where Humans Do? Obfuscation as a Probe of Human and Machine Code Comprehension. *SPLASH 2026, ACM Student Research Competition, pp. 45-46.*

Le, J., and Nguyen, T. N. Attributing Gains in Paired Training: Objective or Data Direction? *NeurIPS ATTRIB Workshop, 2026. Non-archival.*

Preprints and Manuscripts

Le, J., and Nguyen, T. N. Directional Collapse in Fine-Tuning: Preserving the Way Back. *Manuscript.*

Le, J., and Nguyen, T. N. Correct Values Can Be Recovered Before Wrong Reasoning Steps. *Manuscript.*

Le, J., and Nguyen, T. N. Composing Obfuscation Specialists by Merging. *Submitted to FSE.*

Hanke, V., **Le, J.**, Dziedzic, A., and Boenisch, F. Router-Free Modular Storage for Knowledge Unlearning in Large Language Models. *Submitted to ICLR.*

Le, J., Lahnstein Coronado, I., Nguyen, A. H. N., and Nguyen, T. N. Fast Errors or Slow Effort? Divergent Dual-Process Signatures of Code Obfuscation in Humans and Language Models. *Submitted to FSE.*

Le, J., Gelles, R., Aiken, C., and Quinn, K. Extreme Summarization of Worldwide Scientific and Patent Document Clusters for Landscape Analysis. *Submitted to Scientometrics.*

Le, J.*, Nguyen, A. H. N.*, and Nguyen, T. N. Do Machines Struggle Where Humans Do? LLM and Human Comprehension of Obfuscated Code. *Submitted to FSE.*

Nguyen, A. H. N.*, **Le, J.***, Lahnstein Coronado, I., and Nguyen, T. N. The Effect of Code Obfuscation on Human Program Comprehension. *Submitted for review.*

Philosophical Preprints

Le, J. What Does an Embedding Mean? A Semiotic Account of Learned Representation. *Preprint.*

Tanaka-Ishii, K., and **Le, J.** Code as Embedding as AI. *Submitted to Minds and Machines.*

Honors and Awards

2026 DAAD RISE Scholarship; Archer Fellowship; URSA (2 awards)
2025 Barry Goldwater Scholarship; Undergraduate Research Scholar Award
2024 URAP Fellowship; Leland Dillaha Scholarship; ACM Projects People's Choice Award
2022 National Merit Scholarship, UT Dallas

Presentations

- *Do Machines Struggle Where Humans Do? LLM and Human Comprehension of Obfuscated Code.* GCURS, Rice University, Oct 2026.
- *Exact Unlearning for Large Language Models.* DAAD RISE Research Symposium, 2026.
- *Head Shape Analysis Using Custom Feature Extraction.* UT Dallas URSA Symposium, 2025.
- *Evaluating Large Language Models in Scientific Research: Practical Applications and Challenges.* UT Dallas SPUR, 2024.
- *Coding Semantics: Sentiment Analysis for Movie Reviews.* Co-presented, ACM UTD Research Conference, 2023.

Research Experience

Undergraduate Researcher, UT Dallas | Tien Nguyen Fall 2025 - Present
Study how humans and language models understand code and how models learn and reason.

Research Intern, CISPA SprintML | DAAD RISE Fellow Summer 2026
Developed modular methods for removing knowledge from language models without full retraining.

Research Assistant, Waseda | Kumiko Tanaka-Ishii Fall 2024 - Summer 2025
Studied language model representations using recurrence quantification and entropy.

Undergraduate Researcher, UT Dallas | Ovidiu Daescu Spring 2024 - Fall 2026
Developed image segmentation and geometric features for cranial shape classification.

Research Intern, UT Dallas | Julia Hsu Summer 2024
Evaluated language models for scientific coding, optimization, and image analysis.

Student Researcher, ACM UTD | Doug DeGroot Fall 2023
Compared BERT and gradient-boosting models for movie-review sentiment analysis.

Policy Experience

Intern, Center for Security and Emerging Technology Spring 2026
Georgetown University
Built a language model pipeline for the public Map of Science and analyzed scientific and patent clusters to support emerging-technology research and policy communication.

Archer Fellow, The University of Texas System Spring 2026
Completed policy coursework in Washington, DC; UT Dallas Archer Ambassador (2026).

Teaching and Mentoring

Research Mentor, UT Dallas RIDE Fall 2025, Fall 2026
Mentored 10 undergraduates (2026) and 4 undergraduates and 1 master's student (2025).

Teaching Assistant, UT Dallas Fall 2023, Spring 2024
Led labs and office hours for Programming Fundamentals for Non-Majors (CS 1334) and Computer Science I (CS 1337).

Grader, UT Dallas Spring 2024 - Fall 2026
Graded Computer Science II (CS 2336), Spring 2024; Computer Science I (CS 1337), Fall 2025; and Computer Architecture (CS 2340), Fall 2026.

Substitute Teacher, Garland ISD Spring 2023 - Present
Taught mathematics and science in grades 6-12, including Title I classrooms.

Japanese Instructor, Jeremy E. Watson Educational Center Fall 2023 - Spring 2024
Created and taught the nonprofit's first Japanese course for underserved high school students.

Technical Lead, iCode School Fall 2023 - Spring 2024
Designed and taught web development lessons using HTML, CSS, and Bootstrap.

Volunteering and Service

International Student Outreach, Waseda University 2024 - 2025
Taught in Japanese at a local elementary school and hosted English-practice coffee chats.

Vice President, Japanese Language Association 2023 - 2024
Led speaking sessions, JLPT study groups, and exchanges with Tsuda University.

Secretary and Chair, Society of Asian Scientists and Engineers Jan 2023 - Aug 2024
Organized career events and helped pair undergraduates with Texas Instruments engineers.

Reviewer, NeurIPS ATTRIB Workshop 2026

Code Review Volunteer, UTDesign Summer 2024

Officer, UTD Artificial Intelligence Society Oct 2022 - May 2023

Industry Experience

Onplanetz, AI Engineer Intern (Fall 2024 - Spring 2025): Developed educational recommendation tools and structured document data for machine learning workflows in Japanese.
Relativity, AI Studio Fellow (Fall 2024): Evaluated language model bias for legal applications through Break Through Tech AI (Fellow, May 2024 - May 2025).